MARTA KOWAL-BRANDT

QA Automation Engineer | CI/CD & Platform Engineering

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PROFESSIONAL SUMMARY

QA automation engineer with 7 years of experience, including hands-on ownership of CI/CD pipelines, build tooling and test environments. Built GitLab CI workflows and Helm-based ephemeral environments for three product teams, and developed a personal k3s/GitOps homelab with Terraform-provisioned Hetzner infrastructure. Seeking a DevOps or platform engineering role.

TECHNICAL SKILLS

CI/CD and containers: GitLab CI, Jenkins, Docker, Docker Compose
Infrastructure and orchestration: Helm, Kubernetes (shared-cluster namespace-level access; personal k3s), Terraform (personal project), Argo CD
Observability and systems: Prometheus, Grafana, Loki, Linux, Git
Programming and data: Python, Bash, Java (test code), SQL, PostgreSQL
Testing: pytest, Playwright, Selenium, Postman
Cloud learning: AWS (EC2 and S3 basics)
Additional: Ansible (basic), TLS certificates with cert-manager

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

DevOps Engineer | Odrava Health Software *2021–Present*

- Own GitLab CI pipelines for three product teams (approximately 25 developers), covering build, unit, integration and end-to-end test stages and artifact publishing.
- Reduced average pipeline time from 38 to 14 minutes by parallelising test jobs, caching dependencies and moving end-to-end tests to on-demand ephemeral environments; monthly CI runner costs fell by about 30%.
- Built short-lived merge-request test environments using Docker Compose and Helm on the company's shared Kubernetes cluster.
- Maintain a pytest and Playwright end-to-end suite of approximately 900 tests; reduced the flaky-test rate from 7% to below 1%.
- Wrote Bash and Python tooling to seed test data into PostgreSQL.
- Authored internal documentation on how CI works, used for onboarding; mentored two QA interns in 2023.

QA Engineer | Brightmill Software House *2019–2021*

- Performed manual and automated testing of web and mobile applications for client projects.
- Introduced a Selenium and Java automated regression suite for the largest client project.
- Configured Jenkins jobs for nightly regression runs.

Customer Support Specialist (2nd line) | Brightmill Software House *2018–2019*

- Investigated customer issues in logs and databases and reproduced bugs for developers.

SELECTED PROJECTS

Homelab k3s Cluster with GitOps | Personal *2024–2025*

- Built a three-node Raspberry Pi 5 k3s cluster, with applications deployed from a Git repository using Argo CD.
- Set up Prometheus, Grafana and Loki for monitoring, plus Traefik ingress and cert-manager for TLS.
- Provisioned infrastructure for a small Hetzner VPS with Terraform; used Ansible at a basic level.

Merge-Request Ephemeral Environments | Odrava Health *2023–2024*

- Implemented short-lived environments for each merge request, with the application, PostgreSQL and seeded data, deployed via Helm to the shared Kubernetes cluster from GitLab CI.
- Configured automatic cleanup after merge or 48 hours of inactivity; QA and product teams use the environments for feature reviews, with end-to-end tests running against them.

Flaky Test Dashboard | Odrava Health *2023*

- Collected CI test results in PostgreSQL and created Grafana dashboards showing flaky tests by team.
- Teams used the dashboard to identify and fix top offenders; the flaky-test rate fell from 7% to below 1%.

EDUCATION AND CERTIFICATIONS

BEng Computer Engineering | Silesian Lowlands University of Technology | 2018
ISTQB Foundation Level | 2019
Certified Kubernetes Administrator (CKA): studying; exam scheduled for January 2027 (not yet passed)

LANGUAGES

Polish (native), English (C1), German (A2)